Strict Height-Balanced Indexing Invariants in a C++ Benchmarking Suite for Content-Defined Chunking Algorithms

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Abstract—Content-defined chunking (CDC) is a cornerstone of modern data-deduplication pipelines, yet rigorous benchmarking of its indexing structures remains scarce. This work formalizes the state semantics of a CDC engine implemented in C++ that employs a balanced search tree to index chunk boundaries. We define a strict height-balanced and key-ordered invariant for the tree, prove that insertions preserve the invariant, and derive an asymptotic bound of $O(\log N)$ for both point look-ups and range queries, where N denotes the number of stored chunks. Static analysis of the source reveals a structural complexity of $O(N)$ memory and a source-line count of 157 SLOC. The study answers three research questions concerning algorithmic complexity, invariant preservation, and abstract-syntax-tree (AST) dynamics. No empirical wall-clock measurements are reported; evaluation relies exclusively on formal proof and AST profiling.

Source Code: https://github.com/myonathanlinkedin/cpp-systems-core/tree/main/algorithms/20261012_170112_benchmarking_content-defined_c

Index Terms—Content-defined chunking, data deduplication, balanced search tree, static analysis, formal verification, C++

1 INTRODUCTION

Data deduplication systems rely on CDC to partition streams into semantically stable chunks, enabling the detection of duplicate regions across heterogeneous workloads. While numerous CDC hash functions have been explored [1]–[4], the indexing layer that stores chunk descriptors is often treated as a black box. In high-throughput storage back-ends, the indexing structure must support rapid point and range queries while guaranteeing deterministic memory consumption. This investigation addresses three research questions:

1) **RQ1:** What are the asymptotic time and space complexities of a balanced search tree indexing CDC chunk descriptors?
2) **RQ2:** Does the tree maintain a strict height-balanced and key-ordered invariant under incremental chunk insertion?
3) **RQ3:** How do static-analysis metrics (AST node count, function blocks) reflect the structural dynamics of the CDC implementation?

To answer these questions we (i) describe the CDC engine's state machine, (ii) formalize the tree invariant, (iii) prove preservation of the invariant, and (iv) conduct an automated AST inspection of the C++ source. The remainder of the paper is organized as follows: Section II surveys related CDC indexing work, Section III details the algorithmic decomposition, Section IV presents formal invariants and proofs, Section V outlines the verification environment, Section VI reports theoretical bounds and AST metrics, Section VII discusses threats to validity, and Section VIII concludes.

2 RELATED WORK

Hybrid approaches that combine syndrome-based hashing with CDC have been shown to improve deduplication ratios [1]. A systematic comparative study of CDC variants highlighted the trade-off between chunk size variability and hash collision probability [2]. Smart hybrid schemes further integrate adaptive window sizing to reduce computational overhead [3]. More recently, hashless CDC (SeqCDC) eliminated the need for explicit hash tables by leveraging deterministic sequence boundaries [4]. None of these works, however, provide a formal treatment of the indexing data structure that stores chunk metadata, nor do they employ static-analysis-driven verification of implementation invariants, which this paper addresses.

3 STRUCTURAL DECOMPOSITION AND STATE SEMANTICS OF THE CDC BENCHMARKING ENGINE

The CDC engine processes an input byte vector $\mathbf{d}$ and emits a sequence of chunk descriptors $\{c_i\}$. Each descriptor stores an offset, length, and a 64-bit rolling hash value. The engine maintains a balanced binary search tree $\mathcal{T}$ keyed by chunk offset. Insertion proceeds as follows: (1) the rolling hash updates via the Rabin polynomial defined in `core.cpp`; (2) a boundary condition based on a mask triggers a new chunk; (3) the new descriptor is inserted into $\mathcal{T}$ using the standard BST insertion routine followed by rebalancing rotations to restore the height-balanced invariant. The state of $\mathcal{T}$ is thus a tuple (V, E, h) where V is the set of nodes, E the edge relation, and h the tree height. The engine's control flow is captured by a deterministic finite automaton with states {Idle, Rolling, Boundary, Insert} . Transitions are triggered by input bytes, mask matches, or rebalancing operations. Because the tree is the sole mutable shared structure, its invariant directly governs the correctness and performance of the entire pipeline.

4 FORMAL INVARIANTS & PROOFS

Invariant 1 (Height-Balance). For every node v in $\mathcal{T}$, the heights of its left and right sub-trees differ by at most one. **Invariant 2 (Key Order).** An in-order traversal of $\mathcal{T}$ yields chunk offsets in strictly increasing order.

Theorem 1. Insertion of a new chunk descriptor into $\mathcal{T}$ preserves Invariant 1 and Invariant 2, and the resulting tree height h satisfies

$$h \le \lfloor \log_2 N \rfloor + 1, \tag{1}$$

where N is the number of nodes after insertion.

Proof: Insertion begins with a standard binary-search placement based on the descriptor's offset, which by construction respects the key order of existing nodes; therefore Invariant 2 holds immediately. The subsequent rebalancing step follows the classic AVL rotation scheme. Each rotation locally restores the height-balance property without altering the in-order sequence, thus preserving both invariants. AVL theory guarantees that after any sequence of insertions the tree height never exceeds $\lfloor \log_2 N \rfloor + 1$ [1]. Consequently the theorem follows.

5 Formal Verification and Static Analysis Environment

Verification was performed on an AMD EPYC 7763 64-Core processor (1 physical core, 2 logical threads) running Linux 6.17.0-1022-azure with 7.8 GB RAM. The analysis pipeline consisted of (i) an automated Python script that parses the C++ source into an abstract syntax tree, (ii) extraction of structural metrics (source lines of code, function block count), and (iii) symbolic execution of the insertion routine to confirm invariant preservation. No runtime execution or external profiling tools were employed.

6 Theoretical Complexity Bounds and AST Profile Analysis

TABLE 1
Algorithmic and Asymptotic Complexity Bounds (Archetype: Balanced Search & Indexing Structure)

Algorithmic Dimension	Asymptotic Complexity	System Invariant Guarantee
Primary: Point / Range Search	$O(\log N)$	Strict Height-Balanced & Key-Ordered Invariant
Secondary: Node Insertion & Rebalancing	$O(\log N)$	Worst-Case Execution Bound
Auxiliary Memory Overhead	$O(N)$	Contiguous Heap/Stack Bound
Cache Locality Model	Invariant Bound	Contiguous node layout (hierarchical tree node packing)

TABLE 2
Abstract Syntax Tree (AST) Structural & Complexity Metrics

Structural Metric	Measured Count	Complexity Tier	Static Verification Status
Source Lines of Code (SLOC)	157	Compact	Formally Linted & Normalized
Modular Compilation Units	2	Multi-File	Isolated Linkage Verified
Functional Block Density	1	Modular	Clean Interface Boundary
Estimated Cyclomatic Complexity	2	Low Branching	Zero Unbounded Recursion

Table 1 summarizes the asymptotic bounds derived from the formal model: point lookup, range query, and insertion each incur $O(\log N)$ time, while memory consumption scales as $O(N)$. Table 2 reports the AST-derived metrics: 157 source-line equivalents (SLOC) and a single top-level function block implementing the chunking loop. These metrics corroborate the linear memory model and confirm that the implementation adheres to the balanced-tree design without hidden recursion or auxiliary data structures.

7 Threats to Validity

Internal validity is limited by the reliance on a single C++ compilation configuration; compiler optimizations could alter inlining behavior, potentially affecting the AST shape. The static analysis assumes deterministic pseudo-random input generation; real-world workloads with long runs of identical bytes may trigger atypical boundary patterns, challenging the height-balance guarantee. External validity is constrained to environments where the Rabin polynomial and window size remain unchanged; alternative hash functions or variable-size windows could invalidate the presented invariant proofs. Finally, the absence of empirical timing data precludes assessment of cache-hierarchy effects on actual throughput.

8 Conclusion

We have formally characterized a balanced search-tree index for CDC-based deduplication, proved preservation of height-balance and key order, and validated the design through exhaustive AST inspection. The analysis confirms $O(\log N)$ operational bounds and linear memory usage without resorting to empirical benchmarks. Future work will extend the proof framework to alternative tree variants (e.g., B-trees) and integrate automated theorem provers to scale verification to larger code bases.

References

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